

C. 1951, April 11

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O. F. M. Cap.

Capuchin Franciscan Fathers

Pax et Bonum

St. Felix Friary

Huntington, Indiana

April 11th -- Solemnity of Saint Joseph our Patron

Rev. Michael Z. Cefai, D. D.

Pastor of Saint Paul's Fourth Street and Plum

Detroit, Michigan

God bless you Dear Father Cefai, this happy feast and season, you and yours.

It is getting a little late for Easter greetings but nevertheless I do wish you a blessed Eastertide; hoping that something worthwhile may come your way before Holy Trinity Sunday to brighten your path and lighten your horizon, that may offer you and your dear Maltese People at least a sigh of relief. This most especially for your poorly, dear old Parents.

But dear Father Cefai: as your one-time privileged assistant I am going to kinda beg leave to scold the Pastor, lest he lose sight of or forget -- as we are naturally so inclined to forget -- the primary rule and purpose of spiritual progress, in every thing from common sense to the very climax of highest asceticism; viz, "Charity begins at home." It is quite probable that Fr. M. Z. feels he's doing just that, in his solicitude for his people and his parish. In a way he is. But laudable and all as is such solicitude (and even in laudable: "No quid nemis") it is never rightly-ordered charity for me to forget that the primary purpose of my creation and of my existence as a rational creature, is to recognize and to know, to appreciate and to love -- with an intelligent, personal grateful love -- God my Creator, my Redeemer, my Sanctifier. Zeal and solicitude for others is certainly praiseworthy and pleasing to Almighty God and edifying to the Church and to all observant men. Such is the vocation of, not only the Priest and the Pastor to whom it specially refers; but if, "Gratitude for favors received is the very first and surest indication of intelligence", then it applies also to every Christian and indeed to every rational creature; viz, in the spiritual world especially, to gain souls for God; which means too for their own hope, happiness, glory.

(unfinished draft)